SAMURAI EDGE

BAKUMATSU COMBAT CHRONICLES — TWILIGHT OF STEEL

OFFICIAL INSTRUCTION MANUAL & STRATEGY GUIDE

MASTER EXPANSION: 24 FIGHTERS · 24 THEMATIC ARENAS

HISTORICAL ARCHIVE & DIEGETIC DUEL COMBAT DOCTRINE

EDO • KYOTO • IGA • NAGASAKI (1860–1868)

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THE LEGEND OF BAKUMATSU & THE ASH SEAL

TWILIGHT OF THE SHOGUNATE & THE BLOOD PROPHECY

1. O Fim de Dois Séculos de Paz (Sakoku)

In the twilight of the 19th century (1860s), Japan was rocked by the sudden arrival of Western 'Black Ships', shattering more than two centuries of sacred isolation (Sakoku). The realm fractured into a savage civil war: on one side stood the Tokugawa Shogunate loyalists fighting to preserve feudal order; on the other, imperial nationalists and rebel clans demanding the supreme restoration of the Emperor.

2. O Titã Adormecido na Caverna Sombria

Yet beneath the veil of political upheaval and the merciless advance of rifled firearms, an ancient and far more terrifying power stirred. In the impenetrable mountain fastness of Iga Province, buried deep within the stygian depths of the Shadow Cave, lay sealed for over a thousand years the Oni Gashadokuro: a colossal skeletal titan forged from the condensed hatred and agony of myriad warriors and innocents slain in forgotten wars and left unburied.

3. A Conspiração do Despertar

The ancient prophecies of the Onmyodo mystics warned that should Japan's soil once again be flooded with the blood of unavenged fallen warriors, the spiritual talismans binding the titan would shatter. Unwittingly, each deadly duel fought in the burning streets of Kyoto, each ambush in the sacred bamboo groves, and each assassination on the rainy docks of Dejima feeds the swelling darkness, accelerating the return of the starving titan to consume all life across Japan.

THE SEVEN WARRING FACTIONS

ALLIANCES, LOYALTIES & BLOOD MOTIVATIONS

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Swordsmen, miko archers, monks, and peasant farmers who took up arms not for political dominion, but to shield vulnerable villages, temples, and innocent families from the rampant slaughter of civil war.
Members: Kenshi, Tomoe, Daiki, Goro, Benkei
Martial Philosophy: The life-giving sword (Katsujinken). Defending the defenseless against tyranny and merciless warlords.

2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

Legendary martial artists who view the chaos of the Bakumatsu as the ultimate crucible to test their physical limits and spiritual discipline against the deadliest fighters alive.
Members: Musashi, Ren, Raiden
Martial Philosophy: The uncompromising pursuit of absolute martial mastery, where every clash of steel is a direct communion with mortality.

3. Loyalists & Order Servants

Disciplined soldiers and officers bound by unbreakable oaths of loyalty to their commanders, the Shogunate, the Imperial Court, or sovereign foreign crowns.
Members: Saitou, Julie, Ichi
Martial Philosophy: Absolute duty, unyielding military discipline, and steadfast allegiance to the banners they swore to uphold until their dying breath.

4. Opportunists & Chaos Scientists

Eccentric foreign savants, arcane necromancers, and mystic dancers operating in the shadowed crevices of civil war, turning spilled blood into forbidden alchemical and spiritual power.
Members: Hendrika, Valerius, Okuni
Martial Philosophy: Chaos is a fertile laboratory. Traditional feudal morals are cast aside in the pursuit of revolutionary alchemical and occult breakthroughs.

5. Mercenaries & War Privateers

High-seas corsairs and freelance riflemen plying the fractured trade ports and battlefields of feudal Japan in search of gold, gunpowder, and untamed personal liberty.
Members: Anne, Teppo
Martial Philosophy: Survival, coin, and independence. Fighting for the highest bidder or their own crew without subservience to feudal daimyo.

6. The Seal Keepers (Iga Shinobi Clan)

The shadow elite of Iga. Feared as ruthless shadow assassins, they form the secret defense line guarding the subterranean Shadow Cave to keep Oni Gashadokuro chained.
Members: Hanzo, Kasumi, Murasaki
Martial Philosophy: Silent sacrifice. Keeping the ancient titan asleep even if the world reviles them as cold-blooded specters.

7. The Time Traveler & Unlikely Ally

A 21st-century American marine and tactical operative, obsessed with anime and martial pop culture, who was violently displaced across time into the dawn of the Meiji Restoration.
Members: Joe
Martial Philosophy: High-tech survival with anime ninja flair. Upon uncovering the noble purpose of the Iga Shinobi, swore his modern arsenal and doberman to their cause.

CORE CONTROLS & DUEL MECHANICS

DIEGETIC CONTROL SYSTEM & SINGLE-BLADE LETHALITY

Samurai Edge features an isometric diegetic combat system inspired by the classic cinema of Akira Kurosawa and the lethal precision of Bushido Blade. Every single strike carries brutal consequence and 3D positioning demands.

Martial Action	Universal Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Tactical Effect
8-Way Movement	D-Pad / Left Stick	[W, A, S, D] (P1) / [Arrow Keys] (P2)	Tactical positioning and arena displacement
Primary Strike	X Button / Square	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Main weapon slash, quick-draw, thrust, or rifle shot
Secondary Action	Y Button / Triangle	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Special stance, projectile volley, or alchemical brew
Block / Parry	RB / R1	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Defensive guard with precise parry window and projectile deflection
Evasive Roll	A Button / Cross	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Low-profile acrobatic tumble with invulnerability frames
Tactical Leap	LB / L1	[Q] (P1) / [Y] (P2)	Vertical and directional leap over chasms and ground hazards
Pause / Menu	Start / Options	[ESC]	Ceremonial pause overlay upon Sumi-E parchment

Core Dueling Mechanics:

• Blade Clash (Clash QTE): When two simultaneous strikes collide within the same spatial hitbox frame, the weapons lock with cinematic sparks. The fighter who mashes the attack button faster wins the clash and inflicts an off-balance stagger upon the opponent.

• Absolute Precedence: Specific signature attacks (such as Murasaki's Kusarigama Scythe or Hendrika's Piercing Rapier) boast hard-coded priority, interrupting standard swings and cutting off opponent momentum.

• Guard Crush: Caustic acid-coated weapons, heavy artillery rounds, and titanic war hammers shatter parry stances, inflicting extended stun frames upon the defender.

• Surgical Lethality: Combatants possess between 1 and 3 Hit Points (HP). A single clean strike landed during opponent recovery or counter-hit decides the fate of the round immediately.

COMBAT MODES & PROGRESSION

THE LADDER OF DESTINY & MULTIPLAYER CLASHES

ARCADE MODE — THE 12-FIGHT LADDER

The definitive solo campaign. The player chooses a champion and ascends a gauntlet of 12 ceremonial duels where spilled blood resonates across feudal Japan, fracturing the ancient seals of the Shadow Cave:

• Fights 1 to 8: Ranked Duels: Classic Best-of-3 (BO3) duels against 8 fighters seeded democratically across all four difficulty tiers, ensuring dynamic and unpredictable journeys.

• Fight 9: Mirror Match: The champion faces their own spectral doppelgänger within their home arena. A psychological and technical battle of identical weapons and identical range.

• Fight 10: Endurance Challenge: Two elite adversaries in unbroken succession, sharing only 2 round lives. Victory demands discipline and spatial conservation.

• Fight 11: The Seal Keepers (Ninja Gauntlet): Entry into the stygian Shadow Cave. The player must vanquish the entire phalanx of the 4 Iga Guardians (Joe, Kasumi, Murasaki, and Hanzo) amid toxic vapors.

• Fight 12: Titan's Awakening (Final Boss): With the guardians fallen, the thousand-year seal shatters. The gargantuan Oni Gashadokuro rises from the cavern ashes in a colossal 1-round survival showdown.

LOCAL VERSUS & AI DUELS

Direct combat for 2 local players or player versus Artificial Intelligence. Offers unrestricted selection across all 24 fighters, 24 thematic arenas, round limits (1 to 5), and 3 distinct AI difficulty levels (Easy, Normal, Hard).

Martial Prelude — The Philosophy of Diegetic Combat

THE ART OF SPACING, ANTICIPATION & SILENT LETHALITY

1. The Dance of Distance (Maai - 間合い)

In Samurai Edge, spacing is not merely a tactical advantage: it is the exact boundary between survival and demise. Each warrior commands a threat perimeter dictated by weapon reach. A short-blade duelist attempting to contest open terrain against Benkei's massive Naginata or Tomoe's longbow volleys will meet death before closing distance. Mastering dodge recovery and stepping forward milliseconds after an opponent's whiff is the cornerstone of every Kensei.

2. The Empty Mind (Mushin - 無心) and the Blade Clash

When two attacks cross simultaneously within the same frame, time fractures in a Blade Clash. Never hesitate: victory belongs to the combatant who maintains supreme composure and mashes the counter-strike fastest. However, heed the law of Absolute Precedence: certain heavy strikes and signature thrusts bypass clashes entirely, crushing lesser steel under pure kinetic mass.

3. The Sacred Bond Between Fighter and Arena

Across the next 48 pages, each champion is paired alongside their ancestral home arena. The earth beneath your feet is no mere decorative backdrop: it dictates dodge roll deceleration, the chemical reagents Hendrika can synthesize in real time, the elemental pentagrams Seimei channels, and lethal precipice drop-offs where a single throw decides the round.

KENSHI

The Twilight Battousai

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 5.00 m/s (Velocidade Máxima)
Reach: Medium-Long (Frontal Quick-Draw)
Martial Style: Hiten Mitsurugi-ryu (Swift Draw Iaijutsu & Battojutsu)

Lore & Origin: A scarred veteran of the early Kyoto skirmishes, Kenshi once wielded a blood-soaked blade until recognizing that innocent slaughter fed an ancient horror stirring beneath the soil. Forsaking all feudal masters, he swore to defend helpless villagers from the chaos of the Bakumatsu. His art relies on supreme drawing speed, deciding fatal duels in a single breath of razor-sharp stillness.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Iai Flash (Lethal Draw)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering frontal quick-draw slash. Cleanly severs foes and bamboo thickets.
Shukuchi Dash	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Instantaneous shadow dash leaving afterimages. Closes gaps and flanks blind spots.
Sheath Parry	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Precise saya deflection. Parries thrusts and reflects incoming arrows.
Agile Roll	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Low-profile tumbling evasion with ultra-fast recovery frames.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Iai Flash features one of the fastest startup frames in the roster (0.08s). During the resheathing animation (Noto), Kenshi retains 60% walking mobility to reset spacing. Shukuchi Dash bypasses incoming ranged projectiles and repositions instantly within lethal striking distance.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Spacing): Circle at mid-range (3 meters), baiting errant swings while tracking the enemy's attack cadence.
- Phase 2 (Shukuchi Engagement): The moment the foe misses a thrust or commits to a shot, trigger Shukuchi Dash to close the gap.
- Phase 3 (Iai Execution): Release Iai Flash straight along their centerline for a lethal single-strike finish.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Iai Flash has a strictly linear hitbox and requires a brief resheathing window. Flank Kenshi diagonally with agile evasions or exploit wide sweeping arcs (like Benkei's Naginata or Murasaki's Scythe) during his Noto recovery.

Sacred Bamboo Grove (Arashiyama)

Arashiyama, Western Outskirts of Kyoto (Autumn 1863)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The dense bamboo groves of Sagano and Arashiyama served as clandestine hideouts and escape corridors for imperial loyalists hunted by Shogunate forces. The constant rustling of tall bamboo culms muffled the footsteps of political assassins and wandering ronin. In the game's lore, it marks the spiritual frontier where Kenshi meditates and shields rural pilgrims from brutal martial patrols.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Cuttable bamboo stalks blocking initial projectiles and lines of sight. Narrow ravine drop-offs along the western and southern edges where heavy knockbacks induce fatal ring-outs onto jagged rocks.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Moist vegetal humus and rich black loam. Hendrika Gathering: Medicinal Roots and Plant Charcoal (Essential for Healing and Stamina draughts). Seimei: Pure Wood elemental resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Slice bamboo stalks with horizontal slashes to clear direct charge corridors. Exploit dense vegetation to deflect incoming arrows and rifle rounds. Pressure opponents toward cliff ledges for swift ring-out finishes.

MUSASHI

The Dual-Blade Sword Saint

2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.30 m/s (Cadência Equilibrada)
Reach: Medium (Katana Daito) & Short (Wakizashi Shoto)
Martial Style: Niten Ichi-ryu (Two Swords as One Heaven)

Lore & Origin: Unbound by classical fencing dogma, Musashi wanders the Bakumatsu battlegrounds wielding a katana in his right hand and a wakizashi in his left. To his relentless spirit, the awakening of ancient horrors and mythical swordsmen represents the ultimate crucible to prove Niten Ichi-ryu as the supreme martial art in history.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Niten Double Slash	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Two-hit blade chain: downward katana cut followed by upward wakizashi riposte.
Cross Counter Stance	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Immediate offensive parry: crosses dual blades and retaliates with an instantaneous fatal cross-slash.
Dual Blade Block	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Double frontal guard with enhanced impact absorption and high poise.
Floating Stride (Hyoho)	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Lateral evasive pivot that keeps dual weapon tips locked on the foe's throat.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Musashi boasts the highest counter-attack conversion rate in the game. His Cross Counter [R] absorbs frontal strikes and delivers an instant lethal riposte. The second swing of his normal chain features extended horizontal coverage.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Controlled Pressure): Advance steadily with micro-steps, coaxing the opponent into desperate swings.
- Phase 2 (Counter Bait): Trigger Cross Counter right as the foe winds up their primary attack.
- Phase 3 (Niten Finish): If the foe retreats or turtle-blocks, crack their guard with the wakizashi follow-up.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Cross Counter only guards frontal angles. Never strike Musashi head-on when he stands still; flank behind him with rolling steps or deploy ranged artillery (Tomoe's Yumi, Hendrika's Flasks) to punish him outside reach.

Duel on Ganryu Island (Funajima)

Kanmon Strait, Seto Inland Sea (Misty Dawn)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The legendary sandbar island in the maritime strait where Miyamoto Musashi and Sasaki Kojiro fought history's most famous duel in 1612. During the Bakumatsu, the strait became ground zero for Western naval bombardments against the Choshu domain. Its white sand beaches and jagged reefs are swept by salty spray and treacherous tides, preserving the sacred aura of the ultimate martial proving ground.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Deep maritime surf instantly drowning combatants knocked past the shoreline boundary. Beached wooden fishing skiffs acting as tactical rebound barriers for throwing knives and projectiles.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Saline sea sand, crushed shells, and limestone silt. Hendrika Gathering: Refined Saltpeter and Brine Ash (Critical explosive reagent). Seimei: High Water elemental resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Vast, open shoreline favoring technical spacing and mid-range dueling. Dominate the central sand strip; fighters backed into the tidal surf suffer dodge deceleration and risk instant drowning knockouts.

HANZO

Grandmaster Shinobi of Iga

6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.85 m/s (Hiper-Mobilidade)
Reach: Medium (Dark-Steel Ninjato) & Long (Sniper Kunai)
Martial Style: Iga-ryu Ninjutsu (Hidden Blade & Aerial Acrobatics)

Lore & Origin: Supreme leader of the guardian shinobi, Hanzo knows the tale of Gashadokuro is no mere folklore, but an apocalyptic titan his clan has guarded for centuries. Protecting the Shadow Cave under the veil of night, he eliminates any trespasser nearing the seal, willingly bearing the stigma of a cold-blooded assassin to keep Japan safe.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Ninjato Slash	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Swift horizontal cleave with the straight Iga blade. Extremely short recovery window.
Parabolic Leap & Kunai Snipe	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	High aerial vault clearing ground hazards while launching a pinpoint kunai mid-flight.
Shinobi Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Reverse-grip compact defensive guard.
Shadow Step (Shunshin)	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Ultra-fast evasive roll scattering dark ash and leaves.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Parabolic Leap [R] grants full vertical immunity to ground swings and allows leaping across the widest chasms in Iga Rooftops. The kunai thrown at the apex stuns the target for 0.40s, setting up an unblockable descending execution.

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

- Phase 1 (Aerial Harassment): Use Parabolic Leap [R] to keep foes off-balance and clear ground hazards.
- Phase 2 (Kunai Confirm): Land the aerial kunai to stagger the opponent with hitstun.
- Phase 3 (Lethal Touchdown): Execute immediately with the Ninjato slash upon landing.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Track Hanzo's trajectory during the Parabolic Leap. He suffers a 0.15s landing recovery window upon touching the ground. Anticipate his landing coordinates with a pre-emptive thrust.

Night Rooftops of Iga

Shadow Castle, Mountainous Iga Province (Rainy Midnight)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The ancestral mountain stronghold of the Shinobi clans in the rugged heights of Iga Province. Engineered with steep ceramic-tiled roofs and sweeping eves designed to break conventional infantry assaults. Under torrential Bakumatsu rain, Hanzo and his disciples maintain eternal watch over the subterranean passages descending into Gashadokuro's Shadow Cave.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Total vertical abyss surrounding all roof perimeters (instant fall death). Terracotta chimneys and ridge tiles blocking horizontal ballistic trajectories and enabling aerial ambush angles.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Glazed ceramic tiles, aged chimney soot, and kiln clay. Hendrika Gathering: Dry Sulfur and Concentrated Soot (Crucial for Acid Bombs and Smoke Screens). Seimei: Strong Fire and Metal elemental affinity.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Ring-out edge control is paramount. Fighters boasting high-recoil strikes (such as Hanzo and Musashi) can terminate rounds in under three seconds. Strictly avoid panic rolling toward outer corner diagonals.

JOE

The Time-Traveling Operator

7. The Time Traveler & Unlikely Ally

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.55 m/s (Passo Militar Ágil)
Reach: Short (Combat Knife / Kunai) & Long (Doberman Hound Strike)
Martial Style: Modern Special Tactics & Otaku Ninjutsu

Lore & Origin: A modern special forces operative and diehard ninja anime enthusiast, Joe was flung back to 19th-century Japan during a classified temporal experiment gone awry. Thrilled to experience authentic samurai warfare, he pledged loyalty to Hanzo's clan upon realizing the cataclysmic stakes of the Gashadokuro seal. Fights alongside his trained Doberman hound.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Tactical Knife Thrust	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Crisp military combat knife / kunai stab. Lethal at point-blank range.
Doberman Charge Order	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Commands his tactical Doberman hound to sprint across the arena and tackle the target to the ground.
Tactical Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Close-quarters defensive stance with reinforced forearm block.
Combat Roll	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Crisp evasive military dive-roll.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Joe's Doberman acts as a living homing projectile. Upon connecting, the hound deals 1 damage and inflicts an 0.80s knockdown stun, allowing Joe to sprint in and execute the grounded foe with his tactical combat blade.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Hound Deployment): Hang back safely and unleash the Doberman Command [R] to cut off enemy approaches.
- Phase 2 (Knockdown Rush): The instant the hound pins the foe, sprint forward at full speed.
- Phase 3 (Execution Stab): Strike with the tactical knife [E] before the opponent recovers from the ground.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

The Doberman charges in a predictable straight trajectory. A wide horizontal cleave (such as Anne's Cutlass or Goro's Kuwa swing) swipes the hound aside mid-charge, leaving Joe completely exposed.

Secret Forest Outpost

Hidden Grove in the Iga Valleys (Overcast Dusk)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

A camouflaged forward operating camp sheltered beneath ancient oaks where Joe established his sanctuary after being displaced across time. Modern military supply crates sit beside Shinobi scrolls and field campfires. Here, Joe drills his tactical doberman 'Shadow' and hones modern combat blades while deciphering ancient Iga seal charts.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Central roaring campfire dealing tick fire damage upon contact. Destructible wooden crates and military barrels that block movement lines and absorb stray projectile hits.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Compacted dirt infused with campfire embers, fallen foliage, and stray gunpowder. Hendrika Gathering: Plant Charcoal and Coarse Black Powder. Seimei: Wood and Fire elemental synthesis.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Use supply crates as ballistic cover against snipers and throwing stars. Herd opponents into the central fire pit to disrupt defensive stances and guarantee clean follow-up strikes.

SAITOU

The Lone Wolf of Mibu

3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.45 m/s (Caminhada Predatória)
Reach: Long (Gatotsu Penetrating Charge)
Martial Style: Mizo-ryu & Shinsengumi Kenjutsu (Left-Handed Lethal Gatotsu)

Lore & Origin: Captain of the Shinsengumi's 3rd Unit, Saitou embodies the ruthless code of 'Aku Soku Zan' (Slay Evil Immediately). A steadfast enforcer of law and order in Kyoto, he treats rebels and dark occultists alike as vermin to be impaled without mercy. His left-handed thrust is among the most lethal martial techniques of the Bakumatsu era.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Gatotsu Ishiki (Charging Thrust)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Left-handed piercing charge propelled with explosive speed, shattering loose guards.
Gatotsu Zeroshiki (Point-Blank Crush)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Zero-distance instant thrust without startup windup. Crushes parries and kills at point-blank.
Wolf's Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Rigid horizontal blade stance draped in Shinsengumi blue.
Predatory Backstep	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Defensive evasive backstep instantly re-priming the Gatotsu stance.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Gatotsu Ishiki [E] spans nearly 4 meters of range with 14.0 m/s sprint acceleration. If the enemy turtles behind a parry, Zeroshiki [R] at point-blank range crushes the defense outright with an instant 1-Hit Kill.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Axis Alignment): Position yourself strictly along the same axial plane as the opponent.
- Phase 2 (Gatotsu Release): Launch Gatotsu Ishiki the moment the enemy commits to a stride or whiff.
- Phase 3 (Zeroshiki Clinch): In close quarters against a guarding foe, release Zeroshiki to end the round.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Gatotsu travels in a strict linear line and sparks harmlessly off rocks, carts, or walls in Kyoto. Circle diagonally with side rolls and strike his exposed flank during thrust recovery.

Kyoto: Bakumatsu in Flames

Sanjo District, Kyoto (Ikedaya Incident, Night of 1864)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The ancient imperial capital engulfed in infernos during the Hamaguri Gate rebellion and the Shinsengumi's raid on the Ikedaya Inn. Aristocratic palanquins blaze amid cobblestone thoroughfares as the 'Wolves of Mibu' hunt without quarter. The blood pooling upon Kyoto's stone streets directly feeds Gashadokuro's subterranean awakening.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Blazing aristocratic ox-cart in the center dealing burn damage and knocking back careless fighters. Collapsing timber shopfront facades that drop flaming beams when struck by heavy attacks.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Granite paving stones drenched in blood and burning embers. Hendrika Gathering: Gunpowder Sulfur and Fresh Blood Residue (Prime reagents for Poison and Acid vials). Seimei: Overwhelming Fire and Earth alignment.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Dense urban corridor with straight sightlines ideal for Saitou's Gatotsu thrusts. Shove adversaries into the burning carriage wheels to trigger instant guard breaks and lethal openings.

TEPPO

The Tanegashima Marksman

5. Mercenaries & War Corsairs

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.20 m/s (Caminhada Cadenciada com Arcabuz)
Reach: Infinite (Matchlock Shot) & Short (Oak Stock Strike)
Martial Style: Hojutsu (Matchlock Gunnery & Tactical Artillery)

Lore & Origin: A seasoned marksman tempered in the wars between feudal clans, Teppo places no faith in myths or samurai honor codes: to his eyes, black powder is history's ultimate equalizer. Selling his deadly marksmanship to the highest bidder in the Bakumatsu, he scavenges powder horns from battlefields to ensure his heavy matchlock gun remains primed and lethal.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Lethal Matchlock Shot	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Deafening gunshot spanning the entire arena. 1-Hit Kill on connection. Consumes powder.
Stock Strike / Reload	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Heavy strike with reinforced oak stock (knocks back and staggers) or reloads powder if pouches are collected.
Rifle Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Heavy iron barrel defensive deflection.
Disengaging Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Backwards evasive leap maintaining weapon aim towards the opponent.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

The Tanegashima bullet is unblockable along its line of fire by ordinary parries. His heavy stock strike [R] repels rushing foes and inflicts stun, granting the critical window needed to snatch powder horns scattered across the arena.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

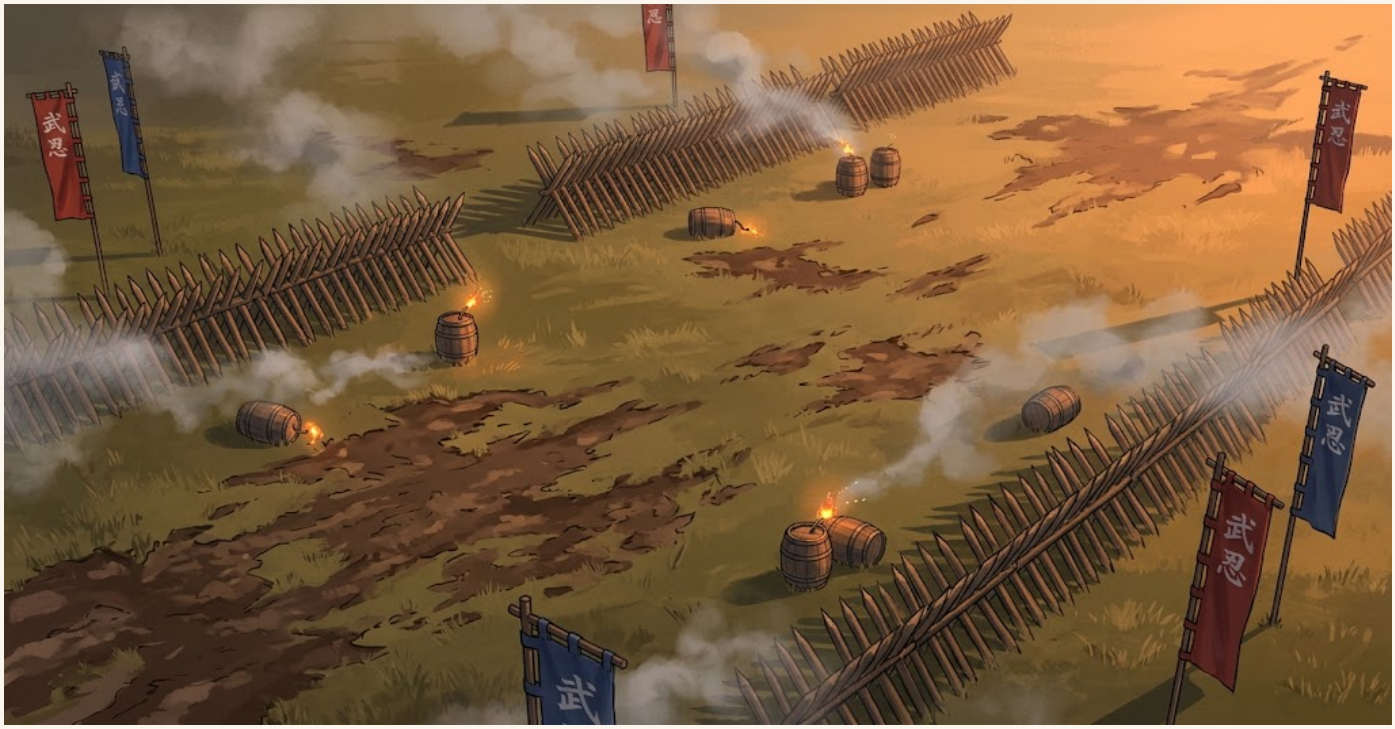
- Phase 1 (Opening Shot): Begin the round locking aim to discharge the pre-loaded matchlock round.
- Phase 2 (Powder Scavenge): After firing, use agile leaps and stock strikes to fend off rushes and grab powder pouches.
- Phase 3 (Reload & Execution): Prime the rifle safely and deliver the decisive second shot.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Never give Teppo breathing room to reload! Smother him with zig-zagging dashes and diagonal rolls from second zero. When unloaded, his combat range collapses entirely to point-blank stock bashes.

Trenches of Nagashino

Shitaragahara Plains, Mikawa Province (Misty Dawn)



Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The historic battlefield where synchronized Tanegashima matchlock volleys shattered the invincible Takeda cavalry in 1575, re-established during the Bakumatsu as a proving ground for rifled infantry warfare. Barbed wooden palisades and muddy trenches memorialize gunpowder's bloody victory over feudal sword tradition.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Pointed wooden defensive palisades that impale fighters hurled against them. Deep mud trenches slowing running and rolling movement speed by 20%.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Heavy rain-saturated clay, oxidized iron filings, and aged gunpowder silt. Hendrika Gathering: Crude Saltpeter and Iron Ore (Enhances explosive shrapnel damage). Seimei: Earth and Metal elemental balance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Control firing lanes between palisade rows to pin agile duelists. Funnel sprinting foes into deep mud to rob their dash momentum, leaving them open to long-range rifle volleys and bayonet lunges.

MURASAKI

The Shadow Sickle Kunoichi

6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.65 m/s (Passo Sinuoso de Serpente)
Reach: Long (Iron Chain Link) & Medium (Curved Kama)
Martial Style: Iga Kusarigamajutsu (Absolute Precedence Sickle)

Lore & Origin: Direct sentinel of the Shadow Cave threshold, Murasaki weaves iron chains through the dark to snare any warrior daring to disturb the Gashadokuro's crypt. Her curved sickle embodies Absolute Precedence: in simultaneous strikes, her scythe cuts first without entering weapon clash, claiming the rival's life in mid-motion.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Scythe Cleave (Absolute Priority)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Curved sickle arc boasting mathematical strike priority over simultaneous blows. 1-Hit Kill.
Chain Throw & Harpoon Reel	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls weighted iron chain up to 5.5m, dragging the staggered rival directly into striking range.
Spinning Chain Shield	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Spins the chain in a vertical vortex, deflecting all incoming projectiles and thrusts.
Shadow Glide	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Low, serpentine sliding evasion.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Murasaki's sickle bypasses weapon clashes entirely: in mutual strike frames, her blade lands first. Her chain throw [R] drags opponents across floor pits directly onto her lethal sickle tip.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Chain Snare): Launch the weighted chain [R] at mid-range to hook and stagger the enemy.
- Phase 2 (Reel In): Drag the opponent helplessly into execution distance.
- Phase 3 (Precedence Slice): Cleave with the sickle [E]; even if they swing in panic, your precedence ensures victory.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Murasaki's chain requires significant travel and recovery time. If she whiffs the pull, she is frozen for 0.40s. Sidestep the projectile and punish her open flank.

Shadow Cave of the Seal

Subterranean Deeps of Mount Suzuka, Iga Border (Eternal Stygian Dark)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

A cavernous volcanic underworld where the founders of the Iga clan raised guardian monoliths and sacred Shimenawa ropes to seal the colossal skeletal remains of Oni Gashadokuro. Miasmic vapors rising from subterranean fissures distort perception. Murasaki guards the central shrine, wielding her venomous kusarigama to ensure no outsider spills the innocent blood needed to revive the titan.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Toxic purple vents seeping from floor fissures and razor stalactites that drop from the ceiling following heavy ground slams. Bottomless stygian chasms situated at the northeast and southeast edges.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Volcanic basalt, bioluminescent cave fungi, and cursed skeletal ash. Hendrika Gathering: Concentrated Miasma and Toxic Spores (Lethal Poison Vial brew). Seimei: Corrupted Earth and Shadow resonance.

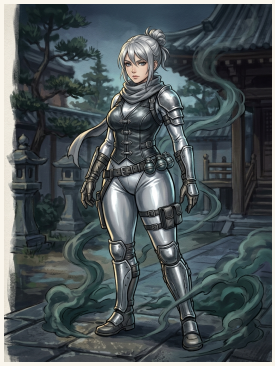
Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Exploit cave pillars to wrap curved kusarigama strikes around solid cover. Anchor fights near toxic gas vents to subject opponents to continuous health attrition while maintaining mid-range zoning.

KASUMI

The Toxic Mist Kunoichi

6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)



HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.75 m/s (Caminhada Silenciosa)
Reach: Short (Dual Ninjato) & Area (3D Arcing Bombs)
Martial Style: Iga Hidden Mist (Chemical Bombs & Choking Smoke)

Lore & Origin: The most inventive sentinel of Iga, Kasumi protects the subterranean passages of the Shadow Cave utilizing chemical bombs and choking mists that disorient intruders. Knowing that bloodshed hastens the Gashadokuro's awakening, she neutralizes adversaries with toxic smoke screens before they can disturb the sacred seals.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Twin Ninjato Strike	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Snappy dual dagger cross-cleave for close quarters.
3D Arcing Chemical Bomb	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls ceramic smoke orbs in a parabolic arc. Leaves dense choking poison mist that blinds and burns HP.
Mist Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Agile blade defense veiled in smoke.
Vapor Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Rolling retreat cloaked in gray ash.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Kasumi can field up to 2 active chemical bombs concurrently. Lingering smoke clouds inflict severe slow and continuous damage to any enemy trapped within their haze for longer than 0.8s.

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

- Phase 1 (Area Denial): Bombard choke points and arena centers with parabolic smoke bombs [R].
- Phase 2 (Mist Corral): Steer the enemy around the hazardous fumes towards map edges or pitfalls.
- Phase 3 (Ambush Strike): Ambush through the smoke with twin daggers [E] while the foe is blinded and taking DoT.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Never stand inside Kasumi's smoke clouds! Pressure her closely: if she attempts to throw a bomb at point-blank range, her throwing windup leaves her fully open to quick thrusts.

Hidden Mist Temple

Tendai Monastery in the Heights of Mount Hiei (Morning Mist)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

An ancient Buddhist sanctuary perched upon the mist-shrouded crags of Mount Hiei, featuring polished cedar decking and translucent shoji screens. Amid the convulsions of the Bakumatsu, the mountain temple served as a spiritual refuge and elite training monastery for Iga kunoichi. Dense highland mist veils moss-covered stone steps and sheer precipices.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Dynamic fog rolls obscuring long-distance vision. Destructible paper shoji screens that, once slashed away, expose unguarded precipice drops.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Weathered cedar planks, highland moss, and ceremonial incense ash. Hendrika Gathering: Cedar Resin and Temple Incense Powder (Stamina regeneration draughts). Seimei: Wind and Water elemental harmony.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Mist patterns favor stealth repositioning and high-agility dodge rolls. Slash open shoji walls to create flanking corridors and bait opponents toward exposed cliff drops behind shattered woodwork.

OKUNI

The Steel-Fan Kabuki Maiden

4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.70 m/s (Danças Rítmicas Flutuantes)
Reach: Medium (Iron War Fan Tessen-jutsu)
Martial Style: Kabuki Mai & Tessen-jutsu (Steel War Fans & Kawarimi Feint)

Lore & Origin: Mystical pioneer of Kabuki theatre along Kyoto's Kamo River. Under the guise of ceremonial performances, Okuni reaps spiritual fervor and crowd essence to empower her esoteric dances. She views the upheaval of the Bakumatsu as the ultimate stage to orchestrate Japan's grandest tragic performance.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Steel Fan Dance	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Twin iron war fan cleave embedded with razor-sharp steel tips beneath scarlet silk.
Kawarimi Illusion Feint	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Vanishes in a swirl of sakura petals upon taking a hit, reappearing behind the attacker.
Open Fan Parry	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Snaps heavy iron fans open to catch and arrest incoming blades.
Kabuki Pirouette	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Graceful spiraling evasion across the floor.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Kawarimi Feint [R] functions as an evasive illusion counter. If the enemy strikes during the feint window, Okuni instantly teleports behind them, inflicting a 0.60s disorientation stun.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Rhythmic Spacing): Keep foes at bay with sweeping steel fan swings.
- Phase 2 (Kawarimi Bait): When the enemy rushes in with an aggressive swing, trigger Kawarimi Feint [R].
- Phase 3 (Backstab Climax): Reappear behind the stunned attacker and execute with the steel fans [E].

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

If Okuni miscalculates Kawarimi and no blow connects, she suffers an 0.35s whiff recovery stagger. Use delayed strikes and feints to punish her whenever the illusion fails to trigger.

Floating Kabuki Stage

Dry Riverbed of the Kamo River, Shijo-Kawaramachi, Kyoto (Festive Dusk)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The historic birthplace of Kabuki theater founded by priestess Izumo no Okuni on the riverbanks of the Kamo River. Raised on pine stilts over flowing river waters, the hinoki wood stage is adorned with crimson silk lanterns and golden fans. During Bakumatsu festival nights, flamboyant dramatic performances masked secret conclaves between imperial conspirators and mystic courtesans.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Instant ring-out drownings in the swift currents of the Kamo River beyond the stage edge. Hanging silk lanterns that swing dynamically and drop embers when severed by high attacks.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Polished Hinoki cypress planks and ceremonial white rice powder (Oshiroi). Hendrika Gathering: Alkaline Face Chalk and Noble Wood Rosin (Blinding smoke mixtures). Seimei: Vibrant Wood and Fire resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

The compact square platform amplifies spatial danger. Sweep opponents toward the open water edges with wide fan arcs and spinning strikes to achieve sudden ring-out victories.

TOMOE

The Sacred Shrine Archer

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Postura Serena)
Reach: Infinite (Yumi Longbow Arrow)
Martial Style: Sacred Kyudo & Purifying Ofuda (Yumi Longbow)

Lore & Origin: Consecrated Miko of Mount Kurama Shrine north of Kyoto. Through divine visions, Tomoe witnessed the skeletal titan rising over the burning capital. She descended the sacred peaks armed with her Yumi longbow and sanctified arrows, sworn to fell the warlords whose slaughter weakens the Gashadokuro's divine seal.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Pinpoint Yumi Shot	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	High-velocity sanctified arrow traversing the entire arena in a straight trajectory. 1-Hit Kill.
Sacred Arrow Volley (Sky Arc)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Draws bow skyward, raining down 3 sanctified arrows in an arcing volley upon the enemy's coordinates.
Yumi Bow Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Reinforced bamboo bow defensive parry.
Shrine Evasion	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Graceful backward leap immediately nocking the next arrow.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Tomoe possesses unlimited arrows with a rapid 0.25s draw cycle. Her Sacred Volley [R] bypasses line-of-sight obstacles, striking targets hiding behind rocks, trees, or temple pillars.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Long-Range Sniping): Rain straight arrows [E] across the map, compelling the foe to burn stamina dodging.
- Phase 2 (Cover Flush): If the rival hides behind props or shrine stones, call down the Sacred Volley [R] to flush them out.
- Phase 3 (Intercept Shot): As the flustered opponent charges in a straight desperation run, loose the direct arrow for the kill.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

The Yumi bow requires a brief drawing windup. Close in via zig-zagging rolls timed to her arm lift. At point-blank range, Tomoe struggles to discharge arrows safely.

Sacred Mountain Shrine

Spiritual Peak of Mount Kurama, North of Kyoto (Golden Sunset)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The ancient mountain shrine where, legend tells, Minamoto no Yoshitsune learned swordcraft from the Great Tengu. Rows of vermilion Torii gates lead to a flagstone courtyard encircled by thousand-year-old cedars. Tomoe masters her Yumi archery in these sacred highlands, safeguarding holy temple scrolls from the profanations of civil war.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Colossal vermilion Torii gate pillars blocking arrows and linear thrusts. Steep stone steps that create elevation shifts impacting projectile trajectories.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Sacred white gravel (Shirakawa-suna), mountain loam, and cedar needles. Hendrika Gathering: Purified Cinnabar and Camphor Crystals (Focus and Stamina enhancements). Seimei: Pure Heaven, Metal, and Wood alignment.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Archetype playground for archers and marksmen. Interpose heavy Torii pillars between yourself and melee rushers, loosing charged arrows as they emerge from cover.

ANNE

The South Seas Corsair

5. Mercenaries & War Corsairs

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.50 m/s (Passo Largo de Marinheira)
Reach: Medium-Wide (180° Cutlass Cleave)
Martial Style: Naval Cutlass Fencing & Black Powder (Heavy Cleave)

Lore & Origin: Captain of a rogue corsair vessel anchored in Uraga Bay amidst the Bakumatsu arms smuggling boom. Anne bows to no emperor or shogun: her goal is plundering gold and military galleons to rule the open seas. Her naval fencing blends wide, bone-cracking cutlass sweeps with explosive bursts of black powder.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Cutlass Cleave (180° Sweep)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Massive horizontal 180-degree cleave. Impossible to evade laterally. Instant 1-Hit Kill.
Powder Burst Lunge	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Ignites a powder charge at her feet, launching forward with an explosive cutlass charge.
Cutlass & Hook Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Rugged naval parry absorbing heavy kinetic force.
Deckside Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Agile naval vault over obstacles.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Cutlass Cleave [E] commands the widest horizontal coverage in the roster: a full 180° hemisphere in front and flank. Her Powder Burst Lunge [R] blows through light projectiles while closing distance in a flash.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Burst Engagement): Deploy Powder Burst Lunge [R] to catch long-range gunners off-guard.
- Phase 2 (Corner Trap): Herd the opponent towards arena edges where lateral dodges are restricted.
- Phase 3 (180° Cleave): Unleash the Cutlass Cleave [E] wiping out the entire frontal hemisphere for the kill.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Anne's heavy cutlass carries an 0.28s post-swing recovery lag. Maintain mid-range and utilize precise piercing thrusts (like Julie's Rapier or Saitou's Gatotsu) to strike outside her perimeter.

Privateer Ship Deck

Uraga Bay, Kanagawa Coast (Night High-Seas Gale)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The iron-reinforced oak deck of the privateer frigate captained by Anne Bonny. Anchored near Uraga Bay where the American 'Black Ships' first forced Japan's opening in 1853. Heavy bronze cannons are lashed with hemp, rum barrels and gunpowder kegs roll across deck planks with the swell, and violent storm waves crash against the hull.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Rolling deck tilt and low gunwales permitting direct throw ring-outs into raging ocean waves (instant drowning). Volatile gunpowder kegs that explode upon fire projectile impact.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Tarred teak planking, crusted sea salt, and naval flint grit. Hendrika Gathering: Maritime Pitch and Refined Saltpeter (Greatly expands bomb blast radiuses). Seimei: Tempestuous Water and Thunder affinity.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Linear corridor geometry favors cutlass dashes and point-blank pistol volleys. Forcing adversaries over the low gunwales on the north or south flanks yields instant knockout ring-outs.

JULIE

The French Crown Musketeer

3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.75 m/s (Passadas Nobres e Velozes)
Reach: Long (French Dueling Rapier)
Martial Style: French Classical Fencing & Cloak & Dagger (Flèche & Riposte)

Lore & Origin: Elite guard officer sent with the French military and diplomatic mission in Yokohama to train modernized shogunate brigades. Proud and disciplined, Julie champions Western fencing as the pinnacle of military grace and speed. When ritualistic killings threaten the diplomatic enclave, she unsheathes her dueling rapier and swirling cape to defend her sovereign's honor.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Flèche Thrust (Lightning Lunge)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Aerodynamic straight-line dueling lunge with maximum arm extension. Clean 1-Hit Kill vital thrust.
Cape Flourish & Acrobatic Kick	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Swirls her royal blue cape in a 360° blinding circle, delivering a stunning high equestrian kick.
En Garde & Shell Riposte	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Fencing guard shielded by a gilded cazoleta. Triggers an instantaneous piercing riposte upon parrying.
Passata Sotto	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Low ducking slide bypassing high horizontal cleaves.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Flèche Thrust [E] boasts the longest pinpoint reach among physical melee weapons (2.10m). Cape Flourish [R] interrupts rushing opponents, blinding them for 0.50s to guarantee a lethal fencing lunge.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

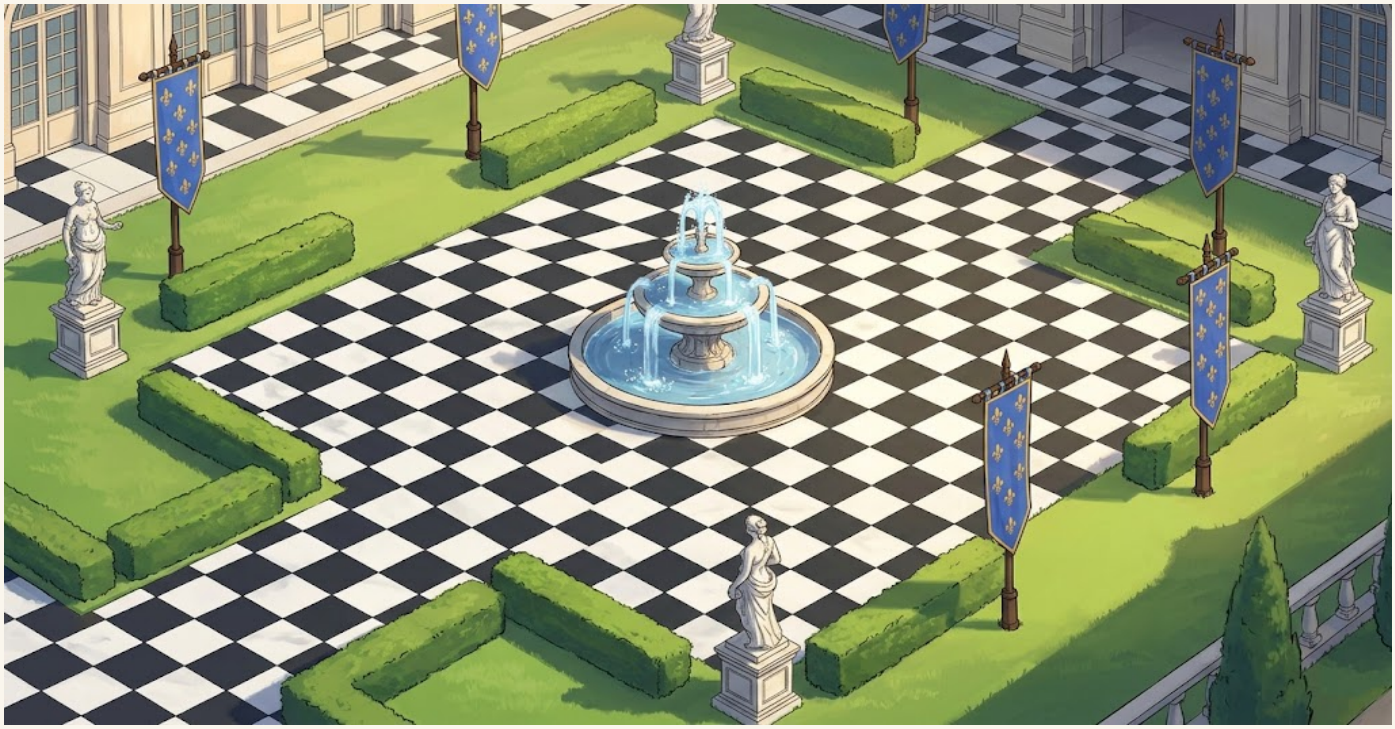
- Phase 1 (Tip Spacing): Hover exactly at the rapier's maximum extension (2 meters), menacing the opponent's centerline.
- Phase 2 (Cape Flourish Check): If the enemy lunges aggressively, trigger Cape Flourish [R] to stagger and blind them.
- Phase 3 (Flèche Execution): Puncture the stunned foe instantly with the piercing Flèche Thrust [E].

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Julie's Flèche operates along an exceptionally narrow beam (0.15m lateral width). Clean diagonal sidesteps bypass her tip entirely, leaving her flank wide open to swift counter-cleaves.

Baroque Court of the French Embassy

European Diplomatic Enclave of Yokohama (Gala Night of 1865)



Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

A classical French palace erected in the foreign treaty port settlement of newly opened Yokohama. Crystal chandeliers hang from frescoed ceilings, gilded marble colonnades outline the grand ballroom, and silk tapestries depict Napoleonic victories. Julie serves as elite royal guard and official duel champion for the French military mission assisting the Shogunate.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Solid marble columns reflecting deflected projectiles and limiting diagonal running lanes. Suspended crystal chandelier dropping glass shards onto the center if clipped by aerial projectiles.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Waxed oak parquet and polished Carrara marble floor tiles. Hendrika Gathering: Refined Beeswax and Marble Dust (High-mobility agility draughts). Seimei: Noble Metal and Light element resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Pristine smooth flooring tailored for fencing footwork and blistering rapier lunges. Weave behind marble colonnades to absorb heavy club or broadsword swings before punishing during weapon recovery.

REN

The Iron-Fist Shaolin Monk

2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.65 m/s (Passos Rápidos e Firmes)
Reach: Short (Iron Fists) & Medium (Kiai Shockwave)
Martial Style: Shaolin Quanfa & Spiritual Kiai Roar (Iron Strike)

Lore & Origin: A wandering monk forged in continental martial traditions who crossed the seas to Japan seeking enlightenment through combat. Ren disdains blades and steel weapons: his calloused iron knuckles shatter forged swords like dried twigs. He seeks duels against the most lethal masters to unlock the primordial spiritual force that shatters the illusion of fear.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Iron Fist Flurry	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering 3-punch barrage. The concluding strike launches the enemy backward with lethal impact.
Spiritual Kiai Roar	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Emits a 360° golden sonic shockwave that deflects projectiles and staggers all surrounding foes.
Iron Shirt Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Impenetrable body hardening repelling blade strikes with ringing metallic chimes.
Crane Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Lightweight acrobatic evasion.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Spiritual Kiai Roar [R] shatters enemy parry guards within a 2.5-meter radius and reflects projectiles (arrows, kunais). His fists deliver relentless attack pressure, smothering opposing windups.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Kiai Pressure): Close in and unleash Kiai Roar [R] to neutralize projectiles and stun the foe.
- Phase 2 (Distance Elimination): Swarm into point-blank range while the enemy is disoriented.
- Phase 3 (Devastating Flurry): Discharge the Iron Fist Flurry [E], overpowering any desperate defensive attempt.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Ren is bound strictly to close-quarters combat. Keep him at bay using long-reach polearms (Aoi's Spear, Benkei's Naginata) or sustained projectile zoning to prevent him from closing the distance.

Mountain Shaolin Temple

Masters Courtyard, High Monastery in Henan Province (Mystic Cloud Sea)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The legendary training terrace of Shaolin warrior monks in the mist-crowned Songshan mountains. Flagstones bear deep depressions from centuries of iron-stance drills beside roaring bronze guardian lions. Ren crossed from Chinese temples to Bakumatsu Japan to trace turbulent spiritual echoes forewarning that an ancient demon is stirring.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Ceremonial bronze bells and stone Foo Dog sculptures that absorb impact. Bottomless cloud chasm extending past the open terrace staircases.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Ancient chiseled granite, red highland clay, and lotus incense residue. Hendrika Gathering: Wild Mountain Ginseng and Myrrh Ash (Strength and Vitality draughts). Seimei: Harmonious balance of all Five Elements.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Reward ground for close-quarters kung-fu and center-ring control. Use lightning-quick flying kicks and palm thrusts to pin foes against stone guardian statues before executing devastating aerial knockouts.

CHIYO

The Twin Nodachi Kunoichi

6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.55 m/s (Passos Elegantes de Dança)
Reach: Long (Twin Colossal Nodachi Blades)
Martial Style: Higanbana Twin-Blade Dance (Dual Nodachi)

Lore & Origin: Heavy weapon specialist of the Iga shinobi clan. Unlike traditional assassins who rely on small daggers, Chiyo brandishes two colossal Nodachi greatswords with the graceful lightness of scarlet spider lilies. Her duty is ambushing advancing armies marching towards the Shadow Cave, cleaving soldiers and cavalry in sweeping circular whirlwinds.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Twin Nodachi Cleave	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Devastating dual-blade sweep with two colossal greatswords. Massive reach and killing power.
Higanbana Crimson Vortex	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Continuous 720° spin with both extended blades, creating a lethal whirlwind swallowing surrounding foes.
Cross-Blade Nodachi Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Locks both 1.5m blades into an X-guard, absorbing heavy kinetic attacks.
Lily Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Graceful acrobatic roll.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Crimson Vortex [R] delivers continuous 360° coverage and overwhelms standard guards if the rival is caught in the storm. Her basic reach is among the longest in the roster for edged weapons (1.90m).

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

• Phase 1 (Reach Dominance): Use the dual greatswords to dictate exchanges outside standard katana range.
• Phase 2 (Vortex Trap): When the enemy attempts to sidestep around your flanks, unleash Crimson Vortex [R].
• Phase 3 (Twin Cleave Finish): Decapitate with Twin Nodachi Cleave [E] during the opponent's staggering recovery.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Following the Crimson Vortex spin, Chiyo experiences an 0.30s dizziness recovery lag. Wait outside her spin perimeter and punish her instantly the moment her rotation ceases.

Crimson Higanbana Meadows

Plains of Asuka, Yamato Province (Crimson Dusk)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

Endless plains carpeted in crimson red spider lilies (Higanbana), the fabled blooms that flourish around cemeteries and guide departed souls across the River Sanzu into the afterlife. In Bakumatsu folklore, the blossoms' deep scarlet springs from the blood of fallen warriors. Chiyo glides among the blooms with her sweeping naginata, shepherding spirits and cleansing the slaughter of war.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Thick carpet of toxic crimson petals masking ground terrain and slightly swaying low projectile paths. Ancient moss-grown tombstones acting as immovable obstacle blocks.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Dark graveyard earth saturated with toxic floral alkaloids. Hendrika Gathering: Higanbana Flower Bulbs and Paralytic Pollen (Prime ingredient for Stun and Neurotoxin brews). Seimei: High Soul and Wood occult resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

The sweeping reach of the naginata reigns supreme over these open flats. Keep short-blade rushers at maximum spearhead range, deploying 360-degree sweeps to deny all flanking maneuvers.

BENKEI

The Colossal Naginata Sohei

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 3 Points | Speed: 4.00 m/s (Passos Pesados e Implacáveis)
Reach: Colossal (2.5-Meter Giant Naginata)
Martial Style: Sohei Kenjutsu (Heavy O-Yoroi Armor & Naginata)

Lore & Origin: The legendary warrior monk who swore to defend Gojo Bridge and Kyoto's sacred temples from tyrannical warlords. Clad in heavy iron-plated O-Yoroi armor and brandishing a colossal naginata, Benkei is a living fortress: boasting 3 HP, he withstands fatal strikes before falling, sweeping his massive glaive to shield pilgrims and the defenseless.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Colossal Naginata Sweep	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Gigantic sweeping arc spanning 2.5 meters. Deals crushing damage and sends opponents flying.
Seismic Stomp & Roar	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Slams his armored foot into the floor, fracturing cobblestones and staggering nearby foes with a shockwave.
Iron Wall Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Anchors the reinforced oak haft as an unyielding fortress barricade.
Armored Shoulder Rush	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Heavy forward stride absorbing light kinetic impacts.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Benkei boasts 3 HP (highest in the roster) and heavy Poise: his colossal windups cannot be interrupted by light jabs. His naginata reaches targets at ranges no standard sword can contest.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Perimeter Wall): Maintain spacing using the Colossal Naginata Sweep [E] to dominate the arena.
- Phase 2 (Seismic Shock): When agile foes roll beneath your blade, crush them with the Seismic Stomp [R].
- Phase 3 (Crushing Cleave): Dispatch the staggered opponent with a thunderous overhead chop.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Benkei is the slowest fighter in the roster (4.00 m/s) with significant recovery lag. Flank diagonally using agile skirmishers (Kenshi, Hanzo, Hendrika) and punish his exposed rear during weapon swings.

Gojo Bridge at Midnight

Gojo Bridge over the Kamo River, Central Kyoto (Full Moon Midnight)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The famed ceremonial bridge of timber spans and stone pylons in the heart of Kyoto where the warrior monk Benkei defeated 999 samurai to claim their swords before meeting Minamoto no Yoshitsune. In the Bakumatsu turbulence, the bridge became the city's most tense choke point, where imperial patrols and rebels clashed under the icy moonlight reflected upon dark flowing waters.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Extremely narrow choke-point bridge corridor with fragile wooden railings. Plunging into the deep river waters on either side results in immediate ring-out drowning.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Massive oak timbers sealed with pitch and wrought-iron structural nails. Hendrika Gathering: Iron Filings and Oak Resin (Stone-skin Armor strengthening draughts). Seimei: Water and Metal alignment.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Highest ring-out hazard density in the game. Heavy club knockbacks and linear charges effortlessly catapult adversaries into the river below. Strictly avoid rolling laterally near the fractured railings.

O-RIN

The Blind Shamisen Minstrel

4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.45 m/s (Caminhada Suave Guiada pelo Som)
Reach: Infinite (Kamaitachi Sonic Blades)
Martial Style: Oto-jutsu & Kamaitachi (Vacuum Soundwaves from Shamisen)

Lore & Origin: A blind minstrel wandering the lantern-lit alleys of Yoshiwara strumming her three-stringed shamisen. Behind her fragile facade lies an acoustic sorceress: her sharp musical chords tear the atmosphere, firing razor vacuum blades (Kamaitachi) that decapitate foes from afar. She feeds on the melancholy of fallen souls to tune her deadly instrument.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Kamaitachi Sonic Blade	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Plucks a sharp chord launching a razor-sharp vacuum blade traversing the entire arena. 1-Hit Kill.
Resonant Fan Chord	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Fires 3 fan-shaped soundwaves that ricochet off walls, staggering anyone caught in their path.
Acoustic String Ward	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	High-frequency string resonance vaporizing incoming projectiles and deflecting blows.
Echo Slide	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Gentle evasive slide guided by spatial acoustic echo.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Kamaitachi blades [E] fly at 16.0 m/s, piercing through destructible props and enemies. Her Resonant Fan Chord [R] saturates enclosed stages (such as Yoshiwara and Rain Mill) with dangerous ricochets.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Acoustic Pressure): Fire straight Kamaitachi chords [E] forcing the foe into defensive dodging.
- Phase 2 (Ricochet Trap): Deploy the Fan Chord [R] near obstacles to create bouncing sound hazards.
- Phase 3 (Panic Punish): The moment the foe stumbles over ricochet waves, loose the direct sonic blade for the kill.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

O-Rin is fragile and possesses no physical close-quarters blade. Use forward rolls [Space] to slip beneath the sonic waves and strike her at point-blank range where she cannot contest.

Night Alley of Yoshiwara

Yoshiwara Pleasure Quarter, Edo (Night Cherry Blossom Rain)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The fabled walled courtesan quarter of Edo, glowing under hundreds of crimson paper lanterns and blooming sakura branches. Behind the glamorous facade of musical banquets and shamisen melodies, shadowed alleys sheltered spies, smugglers, and hunted ronin. O-Rin knows every nook of this labyrinth, employing lethal grace and hidden steel to hunt targets threatening the district's fragile sanctuary.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Enclosed alley arena with zero ring-out pits, hemmed in by low timber balconies and laundry lines with hanging silk kimonos that momentarily obscure sightlines when slashed.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Moist Edo cobblestones, trampled sakura petals, and fragrant camellia grooming oil. Hendrika Gathering: Camellia Oil and Sakura Extract (High-speed mobility and stealth potions). Seimei: Water and Wood affinity.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Claustrophobic quarters neutralizing long-range projectile zoning. Short-range dagger wielders and close-contact brawlers can pin adversaries against the wooden walls for inescapable corner traps.

GORO

The Peasant Rebel of the Kuwa

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Passo Rústico e Pesado)
Reach: Medium-Long (Forged Iron Heavy Kuwa)
Martial Style: Nogu-jutsu (Farming Implements & Raw Peasant Strength)

Lore & Origin: Leader of the Omi peasant rebellions, Goro grew sick of seeing harvests torched and farming families slaughtered by the squabbles of lords and samurai. He forged his heavy farming hoe (Kuwa) into an insurrectionist weapon of war. He fights alongside Kenshi and Benkei to ensure the blood of the poor does not fuel the Gashadokuro's resurrection.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Kuwa Earth Cleave	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Violent overhead slam with the heavy iron hoe. Shatters parries and pins the foe to the earth. 1-Hit Kill.
Mud Stomp & Gravel Throw	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Stomps the soil hurling mud and sharp gravel into the enemy's eyes, blinding and staggering them.
Hardwood Haft Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Reinforced wooden hoe haft defensive block.
Paddy Dike Leap	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Rugged hurdle vaulting over irrigation ditches.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

The Kuwa hoe combines blunt kinetic force with chopping cleaves: it shatters light parries automatically. Mud Stomp [R] slows down opponents by 40% across dirt and paddy fields.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Gravel Blind): Close in and trigger Mud Stomp [R] to spray blinding debris into the foe's eyes.
- Phase 2 (Stagger Charge): Advance with heavy strides while the blinded enemy reels back.
- Phase 3 (Kuwa Slam): Bring down the heavy iron hoe [E] directly onto the opponent's skull.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Goro's Kuwa slam has high recovery lag if he misses the mark (0.32s). Roll sideways and strike his exposed back before he can dislodge the heavy iron hoe from the dirt.

Rice Paddies and Irrigation Dykes

Rural Terraces of Omi Province (Rainy Summer Afternoon)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The ancestral agricultural wetlands that sustained rural populations and feeding feudal armies for centuries. Segmented by narrow earthen dykes and rushing irrigation sluice channels. When renegade samurai bands raided villages for rice stores during the Bakumatsu, farmers like Goro took up sickles, hoes, and threshing flails to defend their family harvest to the death.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Flooded paddy water slowing sprint speed when stepping off central raised dykes. Wicker fencing and straw scarecrows that shatter into flying wooden splinters when struck.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Saturated alluvial mud, decomposed rice straw, and mineral-rich fresh water. Hendrika Gathering: Agricultural Niter and Organic Sludge (Paralytic mud and caustic acid vials). Seimei: Pure Earth and Water resonance.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Fight from the raised dry dykes to maintain crisp dodge recovery. Knock opponents into the submerged mud beds to rob their foot speed before executing heavy, unhurried sickle cleaves.

ICHI

The Blind Masseuse of the Cane Blade

3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passo Silencioso com Bengala)
Reach: Medium (Reverse-Grip Shikomizue Cane)
Martial Style: Gyaku-Iaijutsu (Concealed Cane Blade of the Masseuse)

Lore & Origin: Working as a blind traveling masseuse through the taverns and mills of Kyoto, Ichi harbors secret allegiance to loyalist peace magistrates. Beneath her meek, gentle demeanor, her walking cane conceals a razor-sharp steel blade. Her heightened hearing tracks the heartbeat and muscle twitches of assassins, executing them with reverse-grip draws.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Gyaku-Iai (Reverse Cane Draw)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Unsheathes the concealed blade in reverse grip with an upward lightning slash. 1-Hit Kill.
Listening Trance Counter	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Stands motionlessly reading the wind: automatically evades incoming swings and counters with an unblockable thrust.
Cane Wood Parry	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Deflects incoming edges using the lacquered bamboo cane casing.
Blind Glide Step	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Smooth evasive slip across the floorboards.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Listening Trance [R] is the most flawless counter-stance against predictable strikes. It requires no directional aiming: she slips and executes the attacker across a full 360-degree perimeter.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Silent Bait): Walk forward tapping the cane tip, provoking the enemy into an aggressive swing.
- Phase 2 (Listening Trance): Engage Listening Trance [R] right as the rival commits to their forward stride.
- Phase 3 (Gyaku-Iai Decapitation): Let the automatic slip-counter sever the foe's throat.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Never swing directly at Ichi when she stands still in Listening Trance! Use attack feints, ranged projectiles, or wait out the 0.50s trance duration to strike her during stance recovery.

Mountain Rain Mill

Hakone Mountain Pass, Sagami Province (Torrential Continuous Downpour)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

An aged grain mill powered by a massive wooden waterwheel over a rushing cataract in the Hakone mountain pass. Under relentless autumn rain, the deafening roar of turning water paddles masks all footfalls. For Ichi, the blind swordsman, this stormy mill is home ground: relying not on sight but on rain vibrations and wind shifts to cut down any challenger crossing his path.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

The colossal timber waterwheel churns continuously on the west side (lethal crush damage upon contact). The steep waterfall drop-off to the rear causes instant fatal ring-outs.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Moss-slick pine decking, polished riverstones, and dense water mist. Hendrika Gathering: Aquatic Moss and Millstone Grit (Sensory focus and stamina recovery brews). Seimei: Overwhelming Water and Wind supremacy.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Steer clear of the turning waterwheel unless setting up a throw into its crushing wooden paddles. Rely on straight, lightning-fast linear draws that punish opponents blinded by cascading rain.

VALERIUS

The Prussian Necromancer Diplomat

4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Passadas Sinistras e Nobres)
Reach: Long (Gothic War Scythe) & Undead Summoning
Martial Style: Prussian Necromancy & Sepulchral Scythe Combat

Lore & Origin: Secret occult advisor attached to the Prussian embassy under the guise of commercial treaty negotiations. Valerius is a master of forbidden European necromancy: recognizing that the Bakumatsu harbors the dense concentration of agonizing souls in the world, he seeks to harness this death energy to crack the Gashadokuro's crypt and bind the titan to his macabre will.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Gothic Scythe Reaping	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Wide reaping sweep with his sepulchral war scythe. Long reach that shreds flesh and breaks light guards. 1-Hit Kill.
Skeleton Minion Summon	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Rises an armed skeletal minion from the soil that relentlessly chases and harasses the opponent.
Bone & Ether Ward	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Summons an ethereal cage of bones absorbing incoming blade swings.
Sepulchral Mist Fade	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Dissolves into dark mist to evade oncoming attacks.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

The Skeleton Minion [R] functions as an active field ally: it absorbs an incoming blow or swings an ancient blade, creating the ideal distraction for Valerius to reap with his scythe.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Rise Minion): Summon the Skeleton Minion [R] right at the opening bell.
- Phase 2 (Pincer Encirclement): Advance along the opposite flank, forcing the foe to divide their guard.
- Phase 3 (Fatal Reaping): The moment the enemy turns to swat the minion, reap them with the war scythe [E].

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Shatter the skeleton with a quick strike or circle diagonally outside the scythe's reach. Valerius suffers significant recovery lag after whiffing a heavy reaping swing.

Gothic Prussian Cemetery

Ancestral Crypt in the Silesian Forests (Eclipse Midnight)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

A centuries-old Gothic necropolis enclosed by wrought-iron fences and black granite mausoleums in Central Europe. Valerius, Prussian aristocrat and knight of the Black Order, traversed continents enthralled by legends of Oni Gashadokuro stirring in Japan. His dark quests into immortality and necromancy demand warrior souls, and this frozen sepulcher serves as the nexus from which he summons apparitions into his Zweihänder blade.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Jagged iron cemetery spires and stone sarcophagi impaling knocked-back opponents. Spectral ground fog causing movement sluggishness in the darkest perimeter corners.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Frozen graveyard soil, pulverized skeletal bone dust, and oxidized iron ash. Hendrika Gathering: Corpse Dust and Black Ichors (Valyrian Hellfire and necrotic poisons). Seimei: Extreme Darkness and Nether affinity.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Exploit the immense arc of the Prussian Zweihänder to herd foes toward iron cemetery gates. Pin enemies against stone crypts where heavy overhead cleaves shatter parry blocks and trigger fatal guard breaks.

SEIMEI

The Five-Element Onmyoji Maiden

4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passos Flutuantes Místicos)
Reach: Infinite (6-Element Rondel Ofuda Talismans)
Martial Style: Imperial Onmyodo & Elemental Talisman Magic (Heian Rondel)

Lore & Origin: Direct blood descendant of the legendary Abe no Seimei. Keeper of Heian's imperial cosmic scrolls, Seimei understands that the Gashadokuro is an ancient entity intertwined with the balance of Yin and Yang. Manipulating the 6-Element Rondel (Wood, Fire, Earth, Metal, Water, and Void), she channels incantations to reshape the Bakumatsu and bend the titan to her divine will.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Elemental Onmyodo Talisman	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Unleashes the active spell from the Rondel (Wood: rooting roots; Fire: guard-breaking blaze; Earth: crushing monolith; Metal: supersonic unblockable blade; Water: homing ricochet serpent; Void: control confusion).
Rondel Element Cycle	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Rotates the mystical Rondel to the next element, tailoring incantations to counter opponent matchups.
Sacred Talisman Ward	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Erects a protective barrier of golden ofuda talismans vaporizing incoming projectiles and repelling steel.
Ethereal Step	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Levitating glide scattering glowing celestial kanji across the floor.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Seimei ranks as the highest-winrate combatant in the global simulation (67.9% ~ 70.7%). Each element yields a unique tactical property: Wood (2s rooting), Fire (guard crush), Earth (knockdown monolith), Metal (100% unblockable at 32 m/s), Water (homing double ricochet), and Void (control inversion).

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

- Phase 1 (Tactical Selection): Dial the ideal element counter against the enemy archetype (Metal vs turtles, Water vs speedsters).
- Phase 2 (Immobilize / Zone): Loose the active incantation [E] locking down opposing footwork.
- Phase 3 (Elemental Execution): Once the target is rooted or stunned, deliver the decisive Metal or Fire talisman.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Track Seimei's glowing aura and bottom Rondel icon to read her loaded element. Roll sideways against Wood needles and never attempt to parry the supersonic Metal blade.

Heian Shrine of Onmyodo

Astral Altar of Seimei-jinja, Imperial Kyoto (Astral Eclipse Midnight)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The ancestral sanctuary established upon the estate of Abe no Seimei, paramount Onmyodo master of the imperial court. The holy courtyard features a colossal Pentagram Rondel (Gomanboshi) carved in gold and white marble across the flagstones, aligned with the constellations of the Four Celestial Beasts. In the Bakumatsu, Seimei channels the five primordial elements through the magical circle to suppress Gashadokuro's malignant tremors.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Elemental glyphs in the pentagram floor that flare with mystic flames and shock waves when activated by spells. Four carved Shikigami monoliths at the corners blocking evasive roll paths.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Ritual white marble, jade powder, and sanctified celestial sand. Hendrika Gathering: Alchemical Quicksilver and Mystic Saltpeter (Maximum Potency brews). Seimei: 100% elemental amplification for all Rondel spells.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Dominate the courtyard geometry. Position inside the pentagram circle to accelerate spirit orb recharge. Use tessen fan gusts to blast short-range melee fighters onto active elemental floor glyphs.

DAIKI

The Bo Staff Pilgrim

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passadas Altas de Montanha)
Reach: Long (1.8m Oak Bo Staff)
Martial Style: Yamabushi Mountain Pilgrim Bojutsu

Lore & Origin: Ascetic monk from the sacred mountains of Hida who descended into the lowlands after bandit gangs and deserters overrun ancient pilgrimage routes. Refusing to spill blood with edged steel blades, his seasoned oak Bo staff delivers crushing kinetic sweeps that disarm and incapacitate tyrants, shielding weary pilgrims with resolute serenity.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Swift Bo Sweep	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Rapid double-ended horizontal staff strike. Extended reach that staggers rival balance.
Pole Vault Leap	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Plants the oak staff into the ground, vaulting skyward over chasms and descending with a crushing overhead blow.
Spinning Staff Ward	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Two-handed spinning staff defense deflecting arrows and blades.
Vault Slip	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Lightweight lateral evasive pivot using the staff tip.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Pole Vault Leap [R] clears wide floor gaps and evades ground traps, coming down with a crushing 1-Hit Kill impact over the heads of unprepared opponents.

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

- Phase 1 (Tip Harass): Keep rivals outside threat range using the outer reach of the Bo staff [E].
- Phase 2 (Pole Vault Evasion): When the enemy winds up an artillery shot or heavy strike, vault over them with [R].
- Phase 3 (Overhead Descent): Descend directly onto the opponent's skull for an instantaneous knockout.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Beware firing projectiles when Daiki is primed to leap. Track his landing coordinates and punish his brief 0.20s touchdown recovery lag.

Snowy Pine Forest

Pilgrims Path on Mount Koya (Glacial Winter Dawn)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The sacred peak of Shingon Buddhism, blanketed under deep crystalline snow and five-hundred-year-old red pines. Frost-covered stone Toro lanterns mark the ancient pilgrim trail. Daiki lives here in ascetic solitude, wielding his heavy oak Bo-staff to maintain spiritual peace and shield mountain pilgrims from renegade pillagers exploiting the Bakumatsu civil war.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Deep snowbanks reducing initial sprint acceleration. Heavy frost-laden pine branches that drop snow packs when struck by high swings, momentarily dazing combatants beneath.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Frozen permafrost under virgin snow, red pine needles, and fossil amber resin. Hendrika Gathering: Pine Resin and Pure Frost Crystals (Chilling ice vials and Stamina brews). Seimei: Wood and Water/Ice affinity.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

The sweeping 360-degree reach of the oak staff dominates snowy clearings. Keep swordsmen at mid-range where the kinetic force of the wooden Bo shatters guard postures before they can step into katana cutting range.

AOI

The Ainu Huntress of Ezo

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.70 m/s (Passadas Silenciosas na Neve)
Reach: Long (Traditional Ainu Op Spear)
Martial Style: Ezo Hunting Mastery (Op Spear & Iron Bear Traps)

Lore & Origin: Huntress and protector of the indigenous Ainu people from the northern boreal wilderness of Ezo (Hokkaido). When ominous omens revealed that the sacred Kamuy mountain spirits were being corrupted by Kyoto's blood sacrifice, Aoi ventured south to hunt the horrors defiling the earth, armed with her carved Op hunting spear and spring-loaded bear traps.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Op Hunting Spear Thrust	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Crisp direct thrust with the carved Ainu spear. Outranges katanas with deadly piercing lethality. 1-Hit Kill.
Plant Iron Bear Trap	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Conceals a spring-loaded toothed iron trap on the floor. Foes stepping upon it suffer bleed and 2.5s absolute root.
Spear Haft Guard	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Deflects blade swings using the reinforced wooden spear haft.
Taiga Tumble	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Agile huntress leap adapted for snowy terrain.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

The Iron Bear Trap [R] is nearly undetectable amidst battle chaos. Stepping on it completely immobilizes the foe for 2.5s, turning them into an effortless target for the Op spear thrust.

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

- Phase 1 (Trap Setup): Plant the iron bear trap [R] along choke points or between tree lines.
- Phase 2 (Bait & Kiting): Retreat while jabbing with the spear tip, luring the rival into sprinting across the trap.
- Phase 3 (Spear Impalement): With the enemy snared in iron jaws, impale their chest with the Op spear [E].

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Watch the floor carefully to avoid stepping into Aoi's iron jaws! Vault or roll past the trap and punish her linear spear thrusts by flanking her sides.

Wild Taiga of Ezo

Primeval Wilderness of Hokkaido (Ancestral Ainu Lands, Deep Winter)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The untamed primeval frontier of Japan's far north, prior to being renamed Hokkaido during the Meiji Restoration. Dense birch forests lashed by Arctic blizzards, prowled by Ussuri brown bears and protected by Ainu clans living in harmony with nature spirits (Kamuy). Aoi patrols these glacial taiga forests with her horn composite bow and ceremonial Makiri blade, purging renegade soldiers who bring the rot of civil war into sacred wilderness.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Continuous Arctic blizzard with wind shear altering arrow trajectories. Thin frozen ice patches that fracture under heavy footfalls, plunging combatants into freezing water.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Glacial permafrost, reindeer lichen, and crushed antler silt. Hendrika Gathering: Arctic Lichen and Permanent Ice (Speed Draughts and Cryogenic Flasks). Seimei: Peak resonance with Water, Ice, and Wind.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Use blizzard gusts to mask long-distance bow shots. Lure aggressively charging rushers onto thin ice fractures to cause chilling stumbles that guarantee lethal arrow follow-ups.

RAIDEN

The Undefeated Yokozuna of the Gods

2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

HP: 3 Points | Speed: 3.85 m/s (Passadas Titânicas de Sumô)
Reach: Medium (Harite / Tsuppari Palm Strikes) & Tachiai Tackle
Martial Style: Sacred Shinto Sumo & Crushing Palm Thrusts (Tsuppari & Tachiai)

Lore & Origin: The greatest Yokozuna in Japanese history, whose sheer physical might is revered as a direct manifestation of the thunder kami. Raiden stepped into the sacred arena after challenging swordmasters who scoffed at unarmed combat. Boasting 3 HP and titanic Poise, his open-palm strikes shatter katanas and ribcages as if forged from parchment.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Tsuppari Combo (Seismic Sumo Palms)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Two-hit timed combo: Strike 1 (Harite stagger push) leading into Strike 2 (Morote-Tsuppari dealing 2 HP damage and crushing knockback).
Tachiai Tackle (Homing Body Charge)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Explosive full-body charge coated in heavy Poise. Shoves opponents across 4 meters and hurls them out of the ring.
Shiko Ritual Stomp	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Ceremonial ground stomp purifying the ring while absorbing frontal blows.
Suriashi Footwork	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Traditional dragging sumo step maintaining constant ground balance.

WEAPON ANALYSIS & SIGNATURE MECHANICS

Raiden boasts 3 HP and full Poise during Tachiai Tackle [R]: incoming sword jabs cannot halt his momentum. The second strike of his Tsuppari chain [E] inflicts 2 flat damage, bowling over any rival caught standing.

THE VICTORY CYCLE (STEP-BY-STEP GAMEPLAN)

- Phase 1 (Opening Tachiai): Initiate with Tachiai Tackle [R] to erase distance and pin the enemy against stage limits.
- Phase 2 (Harite Stagger): Connect with the first palm slap [E] to disrupt opposing guard and momentum.
- Phase 3 (Morote-Tsuppari KO): Trigger the second strike of [E] immediately to deliver the devastating 2-HP finisher.

HOW TO BEAT (DEFENSIVE STRATEGY & PUNISH WINDOWS)

Never trade blows head-on against Raiden's armored palm charges or Tachiai tackle! His Poise will absorb your attack. Circle around using lateral dashes and punish his exposed flanks during tackle recovery.

Sacred Dohyo of the Shinto Shrine

Grand Shrine of Sumiyoshi Taisha, Osaka (Ceremonial Dawn)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The sacred clay ring (Dohyo) consecrated beneath a floating Shinto shrine-style roof canopy. Before becoming a sport, Sumo was a sacred Shinto ceremony performed to appease the gods (Kami) and ensure bountiful harvests. In the Bakumatsu twilight, Grand Champion Raiden stamps the consecrated ring to demonstrate that pure physical mass and divine devotion surpass any firearm or steel blade forged by man.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

The raised boundary ring of woven straw bales (Tawara): being pushed or knocked outside the circle is an instant Ring-Out defeat! Massive wooden shrine canopy pillars dealing heavy rebound impact.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Consecrated Arakida clay compacted and cleansed with sacred ritual salt. Hendrika Gathering: Sanctified Purifying Salt and Shrine Earth (Resistance and Poison Neutralizing draughts). Seimei: Sacred Earth and Purity elemental alignment.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

The quintessential Ring-Out arena. Maintain absolute center-ring supremacy. Deploy Raiden's heavy open-palm slaps (Harite) and unstoppable body thrusts to drive challengers over the Tawara straw perimeter for instant victories.

HENDRIKA

The Tactical Dejima Alchemist

4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

HP: 2 Points | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passos Rápidos e Imprevisíveis)
Reach: Short (Caustic Guard-Crush Stiletto) & Area (5 Arcing 3D Flasks)
Martial Style: Dutch VOC Alchemy (5 Chemical Reagents & Field Synthesis)

Lore & Origin: Brilliant Dutch scholar stationed at the VOC trading factory on the artificial island of Dejima in Nagasaki. Eccentric, calculating, and morally pragmatic, Hendrika treats the turmoil of the Bakumatsu as a sprawling open-air laboratory. She perfected a surgical stiletto coated in vitriol acid that dissolves enemy armor and five arcing chemical flasks, synthesizing lethal concoctions directly from the mineral composition of the soil beneath her boots.

Strike / Technique	Gamepad	Keyboard P1/P2	Tactical Application
Corrosive Stiletto (Guard Crush)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering acid-coated dagger thrust. If the enemy attempts to Parry, the stiletto shatters their posture (Guard Crush) inflicting instant stun.
3D Arcing Alchemical Flask	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls an arcing chemical vial leaving lingering hazard pools (Acid: corrosion; Fire: repulsion knockback; Ether: sleep stun; Frost: freeze slow; Miasma: control inversion).
Stiletto Deflection & Smoke	[RB] / [R1]	[F] (P1) / [O] (P2)	Blade deflection veiled in chemical smoke.
Acrobatic European Roll	[A] / [Cross]	[Space] (P1) / [P] (P2)	Agile tumbling evasion with clean invulnerability.

Weapon Analysis & Signature Mechanics

Hendrika's stiletto crushes parries outright with an 0.45s to 1.10s stun. Her chemical pools linger on the ground for up to 6.0 seconds. Standing 0.85s on any ground synthesizes that terrain's formula (Ice for Frost, Stone for Ether, Wood for Miasma, Soil for Acid). Remaining 2.0s on the same material elevates concoctions to Tier 2 (expanded 1.65m radius and boosted potency).

The Victory Cycle (Step-by-Step Gameplan)

• Phase 1 (Opening Zoning): Never charge in straight lines; lob a flask [R] to block the opponent's approach path.
• Phase 2 (Status Exploitation): If Ether connects (sleep), walk forward; if Frost (freeze) or Miasma (confusion) lands, flank with agile rolls.
• Phase 3 (Stiletto Parry Bait): When the cornered foe panics and raises a parry guard, puncture with Corrosive Stiletto [E] for a lethal Guard Crush.

How to Beat (Defensive Strategy & Punish Windows)

Steer completely clear of glowing chemical pools on the floor! Never attempt to parry Hendrika's stiletto. Utilize extended-reach weapons (Benkei's Naginata, Aoi's Spear, Tomoe's Bow) to strike her outside her short dagger range before she sets area traps.

Dejima Warehouse with Rainy Dock

Dutch Trading Post of Dejima, Port of Nagasaki (Stormy Night of 1866)

Historical Context & Atmosphere (1860s)

The fan-shaped artificial island in Nagasaki harbor that served for over two centuries as Japan's sole window of trade and scientific exchange (Rangaku) with the Western world via the Dutch East India Company (VOC). Among timber warehouses packed with spices, anatomical treatises, glass retorts, and imported chemical carboys, Hendrika established her clandestine laboratory to gather rare overseas reagents and brew forbidden compounds under the harbor's ceaseless downpours.

Environmental Hazards & Ring-Out Precipices

Unguarded ocean dock edge along the southern pier: direct drop into harbor depths (instant drowning ring-out). Destructible glass carboys and chemical retorts that shatter under weapon strikes, leaving caustic acid pools across the floor.

Soil Composition & Alchemical Reagents (Hendrika & Seimei)

Soil: Salt-soaked pine dock planks stained with red lead, sulfuric acid residues, and imported elemental sulfur powder. Hendrika Gathering: Pure Sulfur, Fine Saltpeter, and Caustic Residues (The Alchemical Paradise: gathering speed boosted by 30%!). Seimei: Corrosive Water, Metal, and Fire elemental blend.

Spatial Tactics & Zone Control

Tactical haven for alchemists and fencing specialists. Deliberately shatter reagent carboys to lay down acid zones that disintegrate enemy poise. Utilize swift rapier lunges to herd overeager brawlers off the wet dock into the harbor.

THE FORBIDDEN AWAKENING — FINAL BOSS

ONI GASHADOKURO (鬼餓・餓者髑髏) — The Skeletal Titan Forged from the Malice of Ten Thousand Unburied Corpses

Legend of the Slumbering Colossus:

In the unfathomable abyss of the Iga Shadow Cave, beyond forgotten altars and sacred Shimenawa talismans, lies feudal Japan's most horrifying secret. The Gashadokuro is no mere demon: it is a supernatural force of nature, a titanic abomination sculpted from the fused bones of countless warriors, peasants, and innocents butchered across centuries of civil war from the Sengoku era to the twilight of the Bakumatsu. The four Iga Shinobi Guardians (Hanzo, Kasumi, Murasaki, and Joe) dedicated their lives to driving away all intruders to keep the cavern floor undisturbed. But when the twelve duels of the Arcade Ladder conclude and the blood of Japan's greatest duelists is swallowed by subterranean rifts, the mystic talismans rupture with thunderous fury. Twin incandescent eyes blaze within the void, and a colossal skeletal hand armed with iron talons tears through the earth to scour the realm of the living.

Final Battle Tactical Directive

• Unshakable Mass (Hyper-Armor): Oni Gashadokuro completely disregards knockback and stagger from standard sword slashes. Never attempt to contest priority head-on.

• Earthquake Impacts & Titanic Greatclub: Its vertical ground slams shatter cavern flagstones, sending razor stalactites raining across the entire arena.

• Spectral Fatigue Window: Following a catastrophic three-hit assault, the Titan enters a fleeting state of spiritual exhaustion. This is your sole opportunity to execute high-damage clean cuts.

• Single-Round Sudden Death: There are no second chances against Gashadokuro. A single misstep in positioning results in instant and total annihilation.

TECHNICAL APPENDIX & COMBAT DATA

OVERALL PERFORMANCE & WINRATE TABLE (6,624 SIMULATED MATCHES)

Compiled from the official large-scale tournament simulation with symmetric arena parity (Sacred Dohyo, Iga Rooftops, Ganryu Island, and Kyoto in Flames) against NORMAL AI difficulty:

Rank	Fighter	Archetype / Primary Weapon	Wins	Losses	Winrate	Tier
1	Seimei	Ofuda Onmyoji (Talisman Wards / Five Elements Rondel)	125	51	67.9%	Tier S
2	Teppo	Gunpowder Marksman (Tanegashima Matchlock / Bayonet)	116	66	63.0%	Tier S
3	Hanzo	Iga Grandmaster (Kunai Barrage / Tactical Quick-Draw)	115	69	62.5%	Tier S
4	Saitou	Wolf of Mibu (Shinsengumi / Gatotsu Piercing Lunge)	115	68	62.5%	Tier S
5	Hendrika	Dejima Alchemist (Stiletto Rapier / 5 Chemical Reagents)	109	74	59.2%	Tier S
6	Joe	Tactical American Ninja (Shuriken / Assault Rifle / Doberman)	108	76	58.7%	Tier S
7	Kenshi	Twilight Battousai (Hiten Iaijutsu / Shukuchi Dash)	107	76	58.1%	Tier S
8	Tomoe	Sacred Miko Archer (Yumi Longbow / Piercing Spirit Arrow)	107	77	58.1%	Tier S
9	Murasaki	Shadow Kunoichi (Venomous Scythe Kusarigama)	93	90	50.5%	Tier B
10	Valerius	Prussian Necromancer (Zweihänder / Nether Flame Magic)	93	91	50.5%	Tier B
11	Ichi	Blind Cane Sword (Shikomizue / Reverse Gyaku-Iai)	92	90	50.0%	Tier B
12	Musashi	Dual Kensei (Niten Ichi-ryu / Twin Katana Cross-Cut)	87	96	47.3%	Tier B
13	Kasumi	Mist Kunoichi (Ninja-to / Concealment Smoke Flasks)	87	96	47.3%	Tier B
14	Aoi	Wilderness Ainu Hunter (Composite Horn Bow / Makiri Knife)	87	97	47.3%	Tier B
15	Chiyo	Blade Dancer (Dual Higanbana Nodachi Whirlwind)	82	102	44.6%	Tier C
16	Daiki	Pilgrim of the Staff (Oak Bo / High Pole-Vault Sweep)	81	103	44.0%	Tier C
17	Goro	Rebel Farmer (Forged Kuwa Sickle / Seismic Stomp)	80	103	43.5%	Tier C
18	Anne	Privateer Captain (180° Pirate Cutlass / Flintlock Pistol)	78	105	42.4%	Tier C
19	Julie	Royal Musketeer (French Rapier / Precise Counter-Riposte)	77	107	41.9%	Tier D
20	Ren	Shaolin Iron Fist (Vibrational Palm / Lightning Flurry Kicks)	76	107	41.3%	Tier D
21	O-Rin	Yoshiwara Minstrel (Bladed Shamisen / Concealed Stiletto)	74	105	40.2%	Tier D
22	Okuni	Kabuki Priestess (Razor Tessen Fan / Poison Miasma Cloud)	70	113	38.0%	Tier D
23	Raiden	Undefeated Yokozuna (Heavy Tsuppari Palms / Tachiai Charge)	68	111	37.0%	Tier D
24	Benkei	Sohei Warrior Monk (Iron-Studded Kanabo / Titanic Naginata)	64	118	34.8%	Tier D

Absolute Precedence & Priority Directive

BLADE CLASH MATHEMATICS & INITIATIVE FRAMES

1. The Universal Impact Hierarchy

In Samurai Edge, attacks are resolved across 4 strict mathematical priority layers. When two combatants swing within the same spatial verification tick, the engine applies the following resolution order:

• Tier 4: Absolute Precedence (Unstoppable): Signature strikes like Murasaki's Kusarigama Scythe and Hendrika's Piercing Rapier boast hard-coded priority. They bypass Blade Clashes and cleanly sever any lower-tier attack.

• Tier 3: Guard Crush Heavy Strikes: Teppo's blank-charge blast, Benkei's Kanabo war club, and Raiden's ground slams. They shatter active parry stances and inflict crushing stun upon defenders.

• Tier 2: Symmetric Clashes (Blade Clash QTE): Standard horizontal cuts and slashes from mid-to-long swords (Kenshi, Musashi, Saitou, Chiyo, Julie). They trigger cinematic sparks and initiate the micro-mash event.

• Tier 1: Light Strikes & Secondary Projectiles: Shurikens, thrown kunai, darts, and unarmed jabs. Deflected effortlessly by any active parry stance or sword cut.

2. Anatomy of the Blade Clash QTE

During a Blade Clash, the screen freezes for 600 milliseconds as metallic sparks burst from the 3D contact point. The player recording the higher attack button tap frequency overpowers the lock: the defeated fighter suffers 24 frames of off-balance stagger, remaining entirely defenseless against a follow-up coup de grâce.

3. The Golden Rule of Dodge Invulnerability

Evasive rolls grant 12 frames of invulnerability to horizontal slashes and projectiles. However, ground-pounding downward strikes (such as Raiden's stomp or Aoi's spear pin) track low hitboxes, punishing panic rolls mercilessly.

Soil Reagents & Clandestine Alchemy Table (Hendrika & Seimei)

NATURAL REAGENTS & RONDEL ELEMENTS DIRECTIVE

Hendrika synthesizes combat flasks in real time by gathering minerals and herbs from the arena floor. The table below details biome properties and unique benefits conferred upon alchemical brews and Onmy d spells:

Biome / Arenas	Harvestable Reagents	Synthesized Draughts	Environmental Perk
Dejima Warehouse / Harbor Docks	Pure Sulfur, Refined Saltpeter, Acid Residues	Acid Vial (Guard Crush) & Alchemical Fire	+30% gathering speed bonus
Kyoto in Flames / City Streets	Fresh Blood, Fire Soot, Coarse Gunpowder	Lethal Poison Vial & Incendiary Grenade	Inherent fire damage resistance
Groves / Red Pines / Snowy Taiga	Medicinal Roots, Pine Sap, Amber Resin	HP Restoration Draught & Max Stamina Brew	Accelerates dodge cooldown
Cemeteries / Stygian Cave	Corpse Dust, Toxic Fungal Spores, Black Ash	Blinding Mist Flask & Paralytic Neurotoxin	Applies slow status to opponent
Sacred Shrines / Consecrated Dohyo	Sanctified Salt, Camphor, Star Gravel	Iron-Skin Elixir & Focus Draught	Neutralizes poisons and bleed

Quick Guide to Seimei's Five Elements (Onmyōdō):

- Wood: Projectile curve tracing and root entanglements across Arashiyama and Mount Koya forests.
- Fire: Fan-shaped firewalls and rapid ticking burn damage across burning Kyoto streets.
- Earth: Stalagmite barriers and shockwave deflectors across Omi rice paddies and sacred Dohyo.
- Metal: Passive weapon deflection and razor talismans in Julie's French embassy and Dejima docks.
- Water: Blinding fogs and hydraulic kinetic waves on Ganryu Island and Gojo Bridge.

SAMURAI EDGE: BAKUMATSU

BAKUMATSU COMBAT — TECHNICAL COLOPHON & CREDITS

PRODUCTION CREDITS

Original Concept & Game Design: Thiago Carvalho

Code Architecture & AI Systems: Antigravity AI (Google DeepMind)

Art Direction & 3D Voxel Sculpting: Samurai Edge Bakumatsu Studio

Music & Soundscapes: Original Bakumatsu Folk Compositions

Special Dedication: To all masters of epic samurai cinema and the golden era of 90s fighting game manuals.

«A single breath decides the sword's fatal path.
He who wavers before the mists of Iga already rests beneath the earth with the ancestors.»

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